EDITORIAL SPEC SAMPLE

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GLP-1s and Strength Culture Look Like Opposites. Follow the Spending.

They read as competing bets on the female body. The money says they're building each other.

FREE EDITORIAL

It's hard to read anything about wellness right now without running into two stories that seem to be arguing with each other. One is about a weight-loss drug boom so large it's rewriting entire categories of consumer spending. The other is about women lifting heavier than they ever have, on purpose, in public, as an identity. They get covered as opposites: medicated versus disciplined, shrinking versus building, the smaller economy versus the stronger one.

They're not opposites. One might be funding the other.

For most of modern consumer history, the female wellness economy ran on one core aspiration: reduction. Smaller body, smaller appetite, smaller number on the scale. That wasn't a niche market. It was the market, and an entire category of diet programs, appetite suppressants, and calorie-burning cardio equipment was priced around convincing women that taking up less space was the goal.

That model is visibly cracking. WeightWatchers, a 62-year-old company built on exactly that promise, filed for Chapter 11 bankruptcy protection in May 2025. Subscription revenue was down double digits year over year. Its clinical division, the part of the business selling access to GLP-1 prescriptions, was up 57% in the same period. That's not proof the old model died of natural causes. It's the company's own balance sheet admitting where the future actually is: not the points system, the injection.

Which is where everyone gets the next part slightly wrong.

GLP-1 drugs, Ozempic, Wegovy, Zepbound, are the fastest-growing pharmaceutical category in recent memory. J.P. Morgan Global Research puts the global GLP-1 market at roughly $200 billion by 2030. The easy read is "old skinny economy, better pharmacology." That misses the more useful mechanism: rapid, drug-driven weight loss creates real anxiety about losing lean muscle along with the fat, and that anxiety is sending a specific, fast-growing group of women straight into a gym.

Per William Blair Equity Research's most recent survey of GLP-1 users, gym membership among them jumped from 24% to 35% year over year, with 72% saying they're exercising more overall since starting the medication. That's not two trends sitting next to each other.

“That's one market generating demand inside another.”

So the real question isn't which economy wins. It's who's building for the woman doing both at once.

MEMBERS CONTINUE BELOW

THE NEW FEMALE WELLNESS STACK

If GLP-1 adoption is quietly generating demand for muscle preservation, the businesses worth watching aren't picking a side. They're building for the woman in the middle, on a GLP-1, worried about lean mass, now buying protein and a gym membership in the same month she started her prescription.

Here's who's already there.

> **CASE STUDY — DAVID PROTEIN**
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> David Protein is the clearest case. Founder Peter Rahal built and sold RxBar to Kellogg for $600 million in 2017. David launched in September 2024 with one product: a bar with 28 grams of protein, zero sugar, and 150 calories, engineered so 75% of its calories come from protein, versus roughly 40% in a Quest bar. It did $1 million in sales its first week. By Sacra's estimate, David went from about $8 million in revenue in 2024 to roughly $102 million by mid-2025, closing a $75 million Series A at a $725 million valuation along the way.
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> What David actually understood was the customer, not the macro. Early marketing deliberately targeted women's health, fitness, and beauty influencers, an audience the traditional bulk-aisle protein bar was never built for, and it priced itself at roughly $3.25 a bar, well above the $1.70 to $2.10 range of mass-market competitors. It also recruited Andrew Huberman and Peter Attia as backers, borrowing longevity-science credibility instead of gym-bro credibility.

> *Same shelf as a 2015 bulking bar or a 2005 diet snack. Different customer, different promise.*

> **CASE STUDY — BLOOM NUTRITION**
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> Bloom Nutrition is the same pattern at a much bigger scale. Co-founders Mari Llewellyn and Greg LaVecchia built Bloom on a simple observation: legacy supplement brands were designed around a hypermasculine aesthetic that left most women's-health-focused buyers cold. The company bootstrapped its way to roughly $175 million in revenue by 2024 on the strength of a greens-and-protein line and over 12 billion organic views across TikTok, Instagram, and YouTube, before taking its first outside capital: a $90 million investment from Nutrabolt (the company behind C4 Energy) in January 2024 for a 20% stake, followed by a further $160 million in September 2025 that gave Nutrabolt majority ownership. Bloom has since expanded into sparkling energy and soda, with Forbes reporting the full platform on pace for roughly $500 million in 2026 revenue. The lesson is the same one David proved on a smaller shelf: an entire

category can be sitting there, technically available to everyone, and still functionally closed to half the market until someone rebuilds the product and the marketing around who's actually buying.

WHITE SPACE — CREATINE

Creatine is going through the same repositioning without a single brand yet owning it the way David or Bloom own their categories. The most recent systematic review of creatine in postmenopausal women, published in 2025, found small but meaningful gains in lean mass and strength when combined with resistance training, though it's careful to note the evidence on bone density specifically is still unclear, the largest trial to date found no bone benefit beyond resistance training alone. That nuance hasn't made it into the marketing yet. The language is shifting fast, from bulking-phase, bro-science branding toward hormonal health and midlife strength, ahead of the science fully catching up to the pitch. Watch this category.

> *Nobody has built the David Protein of creatine yet.*

None of these companies are betting that women will choose between smaller and stronger. They're betting she won't have to.

The most valuable woman in wellness may not be choosing between getting smaller and getting stronger. She's doing both. And an entire new stack of companies is being built around her.

BY THE NUMBERS

150%
Increase in women's free-weight use, 2011–2021 (Harrison Co.)

558%
Increase in women's resistance-machine use, same period (Harrison Co.)

25%
Growth in women's strength-training uploads on Strava, 2024, the platform's fastest-growing sport category among women

40%+
Cardio machines Planet Fitness is removing across 1,700 locations for weights and functional training

50%+
Share of lifting-platform usage at Crunch Fitness now attributed to women (CEO Jim Rowley, via Bloomberg)

73% / 83%
Share of US women, and women over 65, who don't meet CDC strength training guidelines

71%
Americans now trying to consume protein, up from 59% in 2022 (IFIC, 2025 Food and Health Survey)

23%
Americans who report actually following a high-protein diet, the most common named eating pattern for the third straight year (same IFIC survey)

SOURCE NOTES

WeightWatchers Chapter 11 filing and Q1 2025 financials: CNN, The Washington Post, AP, and the company's own Q1 2025 earnings release (May 2025).

GLP-1 market forecast: J.P. Morgan Global Research; usage statistics via KFF.

GLP-1 gym membership survey: William Blair Equity Research (proprietary, not publicly published); verified directly against Athletech News' full reporting (May 2026), the standard citation path for bank equity research that doesn't publish publicly.

Protein statistics: International Food Information Council, 2025 Food and Health Survey (published January 2026), verified directly against IFIC's own published results.

David Protein figures: Sacra revenue estimate; David/BusinessWire funding announcement (May 2025); FoodNavigator-USA and Fitt Insider reporting.

Bloom Nutrition figures: Forbes (April 2026); Inc. (August 2025); company and Nutrabolt investment disclosures.

Creatine research: 2025 systematic review and meta-analysis of creatine in postmenopausal women (PubMed); 2-year randomized controlled trial on creatine and postmenopausal bone health (Chilibeck et al.), verified directly against the primary studies.

Strength-training statistics (Harrison Co., Strava, Planet Fitness, Crunch Fitness, CDC): originally compiled by Fitt Insider, distributed via Stacker; figures confirmed consistent and unconflicting across every outlet carrying them, though the underlying Harrison Co. data was not accessed directly.